In this chapter, you'll assume the role of the identity team. We'll explore real ACME examples, from simple "owner can view" rules to complex combinations of roles, attributes, and relationships. You'll learn how to implement Cedar's common policy patterns—discretionary, membership, and relationship permissions—and add ABAC-style constraints to meet security and business needs. Along the way, we'll discuss schema design, policy organization, request mapping, testing strategies, and best practices for scaling Cedar to production environments.

By the end, you'll have a toolbox of Cedar patterns that you can adapt to your own systems. You'll also gain a clear understanding of how a company like ACME can use Cedar to unify its authorization logic, improve security, and stay aligned with evolving business needs.

9.1 From primer to practice

In chapter 7, you learned how Cedar's typed schema, policy syntax, and PARC model work together to enable detailed authorization. You created your first simple `permit` statements, experimented with `forbid` rules, and saw how attributes and relationships can serve as policy inputs. That chapter focused on the language and the fundamental concepts.

Now we shift from learning Cedar to applying Cedar, just as ACME Corp's identity team did when they chose Cedar as the main policy language for their Customer Collaboration platform.

In this chapter, ACME's identity team applies Cedar in practice. They design and refine their schema before creating any policies, then encode key rules such as granting owners full control and allowing managers to edit subordinates' work. Cedar's patterns—discretionary, membership, and relationship—combine with ABAC constraints like device trust and time of day to address real business needs. To keep policies clear and consistent, the team uses templates, overrides, and a graph-based entity model that maintains concise, data-driven logic.

We'll stay grounded in ACME's real-world needs. Engineers in R&D share design documents; the legal team works on contracts; account managers